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Ethics and Permissions

Part 1: Ethical decisions in this portfolio

Decision	What was at stake	SAA Code or Core Values it connects to	What I did and why
Honoring the donor's 25-year restriction on the military project files (Coursework: Accession Record)	Wide access versus the donor's agreed limit	Code of Ethics: Professional Relationships; Core Value & Ethical Principle: Access and Use	This is a coursework assignment for a fictional institution; researched standards and applied to assignment
Naming living people in the Southall Brown finding aid	Privacy of living people versus useful description	Privacy; Access and Use	Added to finding aid; names were provided by the donor for historical context and relevancy
Handling the original tapes in the digitization project	Keeping the original safe while making it usable	Preservation Stewardship; Authenticity and Integrity; Security and Protection	Work from copies; do not rewind after recording; keep master and access files separate
Sharing City of Savannah Archives work in a personal portfolio	The institution's rights versus my need to show my work	Trust; Privacy; Professional Relationships	Asked for permission (see Part 2)
Children's lesson plans using the W. W. Law collection	Educational use versus rights in the images and letters	Access and Use; Service; History and Memory; Authenticity	Cited the collection; the items used in the lessons were donated without restrictions

One decision where two obligations pulled against each other:

When I described the Rev. Southall Brown Collection, two obligations pulled against each other. The first was privacy. The collection names living people, and the SAA Code of Ethics asks archivists to protect the privacy of the people in their records. The second was access and use. A finding aid that omits who is in a collection makes it much harder for researchers to find and understand it. I chose to include the names because the donor provided them specifically for historical context and relevance, and I limited the description to the names only; no addresses, birth dates, or other personal information was included. I weighed the donor’s stated purpose and the research value against the small added risk to the people named. If a person were to come

forward with an issue, I would remove or redact their name from the finding aid and not digitize the image or document they are associated with.

Part 2: Permissions and clearances

How clearances are documented:

I hold written permission for the items below. The messages are kept in my private records and are not posted here because they contain personal contact details and internal correspondence. This page records who gave permission, when, and for what, so the clearance can be checked.

Item	Who holds the rights	Permission given by	Date	What was approved	Written record
Mike Williams finding aid	Savannah Municipal Archives	Senior Archivist	2026-09-15	Full use for portfolio; copied version	Held privately
Southall Brown finding aid	Savannah Municipal Archives	Senior Archivist	2026-09-15	Full use for portfolio; copied version	Held privately
Audiocassette Digitization Guide and screenshots	Savannah Municipal Archives	Senior Archivist	2026-09-15	Full use for portfolio; copied version	Held privately
Three lesson plans	Savannah Municipal Archives	Senior Archivist	2026-09-15	Full use for portfolio; copied version	Held privately
Display photographs (4 images)	Savannah Municipal Archives	Senior Archivist	2026-09-15	Full use of displays for portfolio; images are my own	Held privately
StoryRoots and PastPerfect links	Savannah Municipal Archives	Senior Archivist	2026-09-15	Full use of sharable links	Held privately
Coursework artifacts (Accession Record, Deed of Gift, Records Management Policy, Strategic Plan, Patron Relations)	Me (fictional institutions) Clayton State University	Permission is not needed as it is my own work; however, secured permission from	--	--	--

		Program Director			
Resume and certificates	Me	Not needed	--	--	--

Note: If permission is ever withdrawn, the item comes out of the portfolio, and the Build Log will be updated.